Medical insurance policies provide financial protection against hospitalisation, surgeries, and other health expenses. In India, you can choose from government schemes like **Ayushman Bharat** (PM-JAY), which offers free coverage for eligible families, or **state schemes** like MEDISEP in Kerala and Mahatma Jyotiba Phule Jan Arogya Yojana in Maharashtra. For wider coverage, private insurers such as **HDFC ERGO, Care Health, Bajaj Allianz, and Star Health** offer family floater plans, individual plans, and senior citizen covers with benefits like cashless treatment, pre- and post-hospitalisation coverage, and no-claim bonuses. The right policy depends on your age, family size, budget, and healthcare needs.

Health insurance ensures that unexpected medical costs don't become a financial burden. Policies generally cover hospital bills, doctor fees, medicines, ambulance charges, and sometimes even preventive health check-ups. Popular private plans like **HDFC ERGO Optima Restore, Care Health Plan, and Star Health Family Floater** provide flexible sum insured options and lifetime renewability. On the other hand, government-backed schemes such as **Ayushman Bharat** are more affordable and aimed at low-income families. Choosing the right plan depends on whether you want comprehensive coverage for your family, a budget-friendly option, or senior citizen protection.

Government / State Schemes

- **Ayushman Bharat – Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY):** A central scheme that gives poor/low-income families up to ₹5 lakh per year for secondary & tertiary hospitalisation.
- **Mahatma Jyotiba Phule Jan Arogya Yojana (Maharashtra):** Covers free medical care including surgeries etc. for eligible families in Maharashtra with empanelled hospitals.
- **MEDISEP (Kerala):** For state government employees & pensioners, giving cashless medical assistance with good coverage.
- **Karunya Arogya Suraksha Padhathi (Kerala):** Annual cover of ₹5 lakhs per family, for serious illnesses / secondary & tertiary treatment, for vulnerable/poorer families.

Private Insurance Plans

Here are some private health insurance options that are popular / well-rated:

- **Bajaj Allianz Health Guard** – decent mid-range plan, covers pre-/post-hospitalisation, has many network hospitals, good for families.
- **Reliance Health Infinity** – higher sum insured options, includes features like OPD cover, air ambulance etc. Good if you want more than just hospitalisation.
- **HDFC ERGO Optima Secure** – offers restoration of sum insured, good network, decent benefits.